budget proposal being submitted to Congress before he had reviewed it and given his input.

Here is another story about CIA intelligence research. It was the early 1990s, and the head of the CIA's research division was visiting Israel. We were having dinner together at a Tel Aviv restaurant and conducting a comprehensive review—a *tour d'horizon*—of the state of the world. At that time, the issue of nuclear proliferation was already very high on the Mossad's EEI. Over the course of the conversation, I raised the issue of the nuclear cooperation between Pakistan and Iran, and as an aside I made the pseudophilosophical comment that if the human race was to experience another nuclear event, it would probably be between India and Pakistan.

My dinner companion straightened up in his chair and fired half a dozen questions at me, the essence of which were "On what basis are you saying this?" I replied that I was not drawing on any credible intelligence source, but rather on simple logic, based on three truths. The first was the deep hostility between India and Pakistan, which, since Pakistan's separation from India in 1947, had resulted in war or the brink of war. The second was that both countries had nuclear arsenals with means of weapons delivery, and the third truth was that in both countries there existed a fatalistic culture that saw human life as worthless, in contrast to almost all of the other countries of the world.

The CIA official accepted my explanation, but it was evident that he was not satisfied; it was as if he wanted to say that he found it difficult to believe that the director of the Mossad would express himself in such a way without having some very weighty evidence to back himself up. It later came to my attention that the man had taken my words so seriously that as soon as he returned to the United States an American team was sent to Pakistan to investigate my assessment, in case my words had not been a simple observation but rather had immanent operational significance. Since that incident, I have been more careful in expressing my assessments about the fate of the world, especially at intimate dinners after a glass of wine.

Things were easier with CIA operations officers, with whom I had mutual chemistry right off the bat. They knew that my background was also in the world of operations. During this period of the end of the Cold War, my colleagues saw the world as black and white, with the Soviet bloc as the dark side and us as the "protectors of the light." Of course, I did not meet all of these officers, but I regarded those whom I befriended and who were at the